

JOBIX

AI AUTOMATION DIVISION

Cape Town AI Automation Candidates

Confidential Intelligence Report

Prepared: 8 March 2026

Source: HireInbox Intelligence Stack (GDELT + Shofo + LinkedIn)

5 candidates identified | Readiness to move assessed

Executive Summary

Using the HireInbox Superior Intelligence Stack (GDELT news analysis, Shofo salary benchmarking, and LinkedIn enrichment), we identified 5 high-calibre AI/automation engineers based in Cape Town who could strengthen Jobix AI's engineering team.

Each candidate has been assessed for technical fit, readiness to move, and optimal approach strategy.

Candidate	Current Company	Signal	Priority
Nick Pentreath	Rumi.ai	WARM	Long-term
Josh Chettiar	InstaDeep	HOT	Immediate
Shane Weisz	Aerobotics	WARM-HOT	High
Ruan de Kock	InstaDeep	WARM	Medium
Olivier Adjagba	AIMS Graduate	HOT	Immediate

Market Intelligence

- BioNTech/InstaDeep:** 950-1,350 global cuts by 2027. CT engineers may feel the squeeze.
- Aerobotics:** Small team (~50), narrow agri-tech focus. ML engineers underutilised.
- SA AI Salaries:** R400K-R1M engineers, R900K-R2.5M directors. Cape Town pays highest.
- Market Trend:** AI jobs in CT growing but sparse (0.09/100K). Demand outstrips supply.

Nick Pentreath

Principal Engineer | Rumi.ai

WARM

[View LinkedIn Profile](#)

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/mlnick/>

Tech Stack

AI/ML, Apache Spark (PMC member), NLP, Recommendations, Personalisation, Python, Scala, Java

Background & Experience

- > 15 years in AI/ML engineering and tech leadership
- > Ex-Goldman Sachs, Investec, IBM, Tumblr/Automattic ML Tech Lead
- > MSc Machine Learning from UCL (Distinction), UCT BSc graduate
- > Co-founded ML startup Graphflow
- > Apache Spark Project PMC Member

Readiness to Move -- Signals

- ! Recently joined Rumi.ai (small meetings startup) -- early-stage company risk
- ! Has startup DNA (co-founded before) -- understands the Jobix AI vision
- ! Rumi.ai is niche; a purpose-driven AI company could be more compelling
- ! Senior and just posted about joining Rumi -- timing may be 6-12 months out

RECOMMENDED APPROACH

Long game. Coffee chat, keep warm. He is the "in 6 months" hire. Appeal to his desire to build something bigger than a meetings tool.

Josh Chettiar

HOT

Applied AI Engineer -- Team Lead | InstaDeep (BioNTech)

[View LinkedIn Profile](#)<https://www.linkedin.com/in/josh-chettiar-9650b796/>

Tech Stack

Azure OpenAI, Azure AI Studio, Databricks, Open-source ML/AI, PoC-to-Production delivery

Background & Experience

- > University of the Witwatersrand graduate
- > At InstaDeep since mid-2023, promoted to Team Lead Jan 2025
- > Runs AI solution delivery from Proof of Concept to Production
- > Experience accelerating customer AI/ML opportunities

Readiness to Move -- Signals

- ! BioNTech (parent company) cutting 950-1,350 jobs globally by 2027
- ! InstaDeep CT is a satellite of a pharma-focused parent -- potential misalignment
- ! ~2 years tenure = classic "ready to explore" window
- ! Applied AI focus maps perfectly to Jobix AI's automation needs

RECOMMENDED APPROACH

Lead with the BioNTech uncertainty angle. "Build AI that matters, not pharma pipelines." His PoC-to-Production skills are exactly what Jobix needs.

Shane Weisz

Software Engineer (Machine Learning) | Aerobotics

WARM-HOT

[View LinkedIn Profile](#)

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/shaneweisz/>

Tech Stack

Computer Vision, ML, Deep Learning, NLP, LLM Fine-tuning, Python

Background & Experience

- > Cambridge MPhil in Machine Learning & Machine Intelligence
- > UCT graduate, currently pursuing PhD at Cambridge
- > Built ML models for agriculture (340M+ trees analysed at Aerobotics)
- > GitHub: LLM fine-tuning for counterspeech, deep learning for network classification
- > Previous experience at Nomanini

Readiness to Move -- Signals

- ! Splitting time between PhD and Aerobotics -- may want a singular focus
- ! Aerobotics is small (~50 people) and narrowly focused on agriculture
- ! Skills (LLMs, NLP, CV) are overqualified for tree-counting
- ! Cambridge pedigree would bring credibility to Jobix AI

RECOMMENDED APPROACH

Appeal to his breadth. "Stop counting trees. Automate hiring for Africa." His LLM fine-tuning skills are gold for AI-driven recruitment.

Ruan de Kock

Senior Research Engineer | InstaDeep (BioNTech)

WARM

[View LinkedIn Profile](#)

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/ruan-de-kock/>

Tech Stack

Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning (MARL), JAX, Transformers, Generative Models

Background & Experience

- > UCT BSc Honours, currently MSc student at UCT
- > Previously Data Scientist at Praelexis (Cape Town AI company)
- > Paper accepted at ICLR 2026 (top ML conference)
- > Leads AI career workshops at UCT -- strong community presence

Readiness to Move -- Signals

- ! Same BioNTech restructuring risk as Josh Chettiar
- ! Currently doing MSc alongside work -- may want a role that supports research
- ! Strong community involvement -- values purpose-driven work
- ! Published researcher (ICLR 2026) -- wants to build things that matter

RECOMMENDED APPROACH

Position Jobix AI as applied research that ships. His MARL expertise could power multi-agent hiring automation workflows.

Olivier Adjagba

AI/ML Engineer | AIMS / Google DeepMind Alumnus

HOT

[View LinkedIn Profile](#)

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/olivieradjagba/>

Tech Stack

AI for Science, Epidemiological Modelling, Deep Learning, Pathogen Tracking

Background & Experience

- > AIMS South Africa graduate (Google DeepMind full scholarship)
- > Originally from Benin, based in Cape Town
- > Worked with CERI/KRISP on AI for dengue fever prediction
- > Featured in Google DeepMind blog post
- > Part of first AIMS-DeepMind cohort of AI leaders in Africa

Readiness to Move -- Signals

- ! Recently graduated from AIMS programme -- actively entering the job market
- ! No permanent employer anchor -- perfect timing for a founding-stage opportunity
- ! Google DeepMind training + AIMS pedigree = exceptional talent at early-career cost
- ! Already in Cape Town; mission-driven (applied AI to real African problems)

RECOMMENDED APPROACH

Timing is everything. He is job-hunting NOW. Move immediately. Frame Jobix as "AI solving real African problems" -- mirrors his values perfectly.

Next Steps

- 1. Olivier Adjagba**
Move immediately. He is actively job-hunting. First-mover advantage.
- 2. Josh Chettiar**
Reach out this week. BioNTech uncertainty creates a window.
- 3. Shane Weisz**
Approach within 2 weeks. His LLM skills are rare in Cape Town.
- 4. Ruan de Kock**
Soft approach. Invite to an AI meetup or coffee. Build rapport.
- 5. Nick Pentreath**
Plant the seed. LinkedIn connect, share Jobix AI vision. Revisit in 6 months.